SAVMUN

ST. DOMINIC SAVIO HIGH SCHOOL

BACKGROUNDGUIDE | WHO

LETTERS TO DELEGATES
FROM THE CHAIR

Dear Delegates,

Welcome to the World Health Organization! My name is [Your Name], and I am so excited to be your chair for this conference.

Imagine if you felt sick, but there was no doctor in your town, or if you needed medicine but it cost more money than your family earns in a month. For millions of people, this is a daily reality. Today, we are here to talk about Health Equity, which is a fancy way of saying that everyone should have a fair chance to be healthy, no matter how much money they have or where they live.

As delegates, you will work together to find ways to bring clinics, vaccines, and doctors to the places that need them most. I can't wait to hear your healthy ideas!

Image of Chair

Best wishes,

[Your Name,] Chair

INTRODUCTION

The WHO is the part of the United Nations that looks out for the health of everyone on Earth. Our goal is Universal Health Coverage (UHC). This means that all people should get the health services they need without struggling to pay for them.

Currently, at least half of the world's population does not have full coverage for basic health services. In low income communities, even a simple check up can be impossible to get. To fix this, we need countries to cooperate by sharing medical tools, training doctors, and lowering the cost of medicine.

TOPIC:

Improving Access to Basic Healthcare for Low Income Communities

STATEMENT OF THE PROBLEM

In many low income areas, people face barriers that stop them from getting healthy:

- Distance: In rural areas, the nearest hospital might be a day's walk away.
- Cost: Many families have to choose between buying food or buying medicine.
- Shortage of Workers: There aren't enough trained doctors and nurses in many developing countries.

- Preventable Diseases: many people die from things that are easy to treat, like dehydration or the flu, simply because they can’t reach a clinic in time.

HISTORY OF THE PROBLEM

- 1948: The WHO was founded on the principle that health is a human right.
- 1978 Declaration of Alma-Ata: Countries met and agreed that Primary Health Care (basic clinics) is the key to health for all.
- SDG 3 (Good Health and Well Being): In 2015, the UN set a goal to ensure healthy lives and promote well being for all ages by 2030.
- The Covid 19 Lesson: The recent pandemic showed that when one community is sick and doesn't have healthcare, it can affect the whole world.

CURRENT SITUATION

The WHO is currently focusing on three main areas to help low income communities:

- Primary Health Care: Building small clinics in villages so people don't have to travel to big cities.
- Essential medicines: Working with companies to make life saving drugs cheaper.
- Telehealth: Using cell phones and the internet to let doctors talk to patients in remote areas.

QUESTIONS TO CONSIDER

- How can your country help train community health workers (local people who learn basic first aid to help their neighbors)?
- What can we do to make sure vaccines reach kids in the most remote parts of the world?
- How can wealthy countries help poorer countries build better hospitals?
- Should medicine be free for people who are living in poverty?

LIST OF COUNTRIES (DELEGATION)

Americas:
United States
Brazil
Mexico
Canada

Africa:
Nigeria
Ethiopia
South Africa
Kenya
Rwanda
Egypt

Oceania and Island Nations:
Cuba
Haiti
Australia

Europe:
Germany
United Kingdom
Switzerland
France

Asia and the Middle East:
China
India
Vietnam
Indonesia
Japan
Pakistan
Bangladesh
Thailand

KEY TERMS

- Universal Health Coverage (UHC): Ensuring all people can use the health services they need without financial hardship
- Primary Health Care: Basic, everyday healthcare like check ups, vaccines, and treatment for common colds.
- Health Equity: When everyone has the same opportunity to be as healthy as possible.
- Communicable Disease: Illnesses that can spread from person to person, like flu or malaria.
- Essential medicines: A list of the most important medicines that every country's health system should always have available.

WORK CITED & RESEARCH FOR STUDENTS:

- WHO - Universal Health Coverage: https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/universal-health-coverage-(uhc (Information on the goal of health for all)
- CDC Foundation: https://www.cdcfoundation.org/ (Articles on how global health affects everyone).
- Our World in Data - Health: https://ourworldindata.org/health-meta (Charts and maps showing health around the world).
- UNICEF Health: https://www.unicef.org/health (Information on how basic healthcare saves children's lives).